

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 8 2

♥ J 9 7 3

♦ A 6

♣ K 9

♠ A K 4

♥ A 10 8 6 5

♦ Q 3

♣ A J 4



♠ 7 6 5

♥ K Q

♦ 8 7 5 2

♣ Q 10 8 2

♠ Q 3

♥ 4 2

♦ K J 10 9 4

♣ 7 6 5 3

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠J

make the contract.

Just don't foul up on your ♠ entry.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 5

You need 4 more winners, and they will come from the ♦ suit once you have knocked out the ♦A. But there is one danger to avoid - if the defenders don't take the ♦A on the first round dummy won't have a ♦ to lead back to your hand. So to make sure you have an entry back you win the first trick with dummy's ♠K, saving your ♠Q.

Next start playing ♦s, first ♦Q, then ♦K. Assume the defenders take their ♦A on the second round.

Win whatever they now play and come to your hand with the ♠Q to enjoy your three established ♦s for 9 tricks total.

Establishing the ♦s is the straightforward way to

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 6
♥ A J 9 8
♦ 9 4
♣ Q 10 7 3

♠ Q 10 2

♥ 7 3

♦ K 8 7 6 3

♣ 8 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4

♥ K Q 10 6 5

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ K J 6

♠ A K J 9 5 3

♥ 4 2

♦ A 5

♣ A 9 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 6			

(pulling West's last trump), and discard a ♥ or ♣ loser on the ♦ 8.

You had to establish the ♦ s to make 10 tricks. And once again you had to pay close attention to entries.

You were counting on North to have a little better hand than that! South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♠ 6, East plays ♠ 4.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

You must find a place for one of those losers and that will mean establishing the ♦ suit. If ♦ s split 3-3 that will be pretty easy so you should plan to deal with a 4-2 split. Dummy entries are limited so win the first trick in your hand with the ♠ A.

Before you pull any trumps you start on the ♦ s by playing ♦ A, ♦ K and then ruffing a ♦ with the ♠ K. West follows to the first two, then discards a ♥.

Play a small trump to dummy's ♠ 10 (East shows out) and ruff another ♦ with the ♠ J.

Dummy's last ♦ is now good. Play a ♠ to the ♠ Q,

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ K 10 5 4
 ♦ J 10 9 5 3
 ♣ 10 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 7 6 2

♦ 8 6

♣ A K Q 4 3



♠ Q 10 9 6 3

♥ Q 9

♦ K 4

♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A Q 7 2

♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

have come up one trick short.

North's ♣ bid was Stayman, but he didn't match ♠s. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦ J, East plays ♦ K.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 8

With the ♦ K onside you have 8 tricks, and only need one more. If ♣s split 3-3 you can get 2 extras and make an overtrick. But when you are missing 6 cards they are more likely to be 4-2 than 3-3. Since you only need 4 ♣ tricks you should establish the suit with a duck.

Win the ♦ A and play a small ♣ from each hand.

The defense gets a cheap trick in ♣s but you don't mind because you still have a small ♣ for an entry to dummy. You win whatever they return and take the rest of your winners, including 4 tricks in ♣s!

If you had played the ♣s from the top you would

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ K Q 9 5 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ A K 8 7 6 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9 6 3
 ♥ 7 6 2
 ♦ K Q 10 5
 ♣ J

♠ A K 7 2
 ♥ A 8 3
 ♦ A 9 6 4
 ♣ 9 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥5			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥5, East plays the ♥2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You are very lucky. Apparently West led from ♥ K Q so you won an undeserved ♥ trick. Now, if ♣s split 2-2 you can make 12 tricks! But hold it a minute. If you play dummy's two top ♣s and they **DON'T** split 2-2 you will only win two ♣ tricks and the contract will fail. Instead you should play a small ♣ from dummy right now. The defenders will win the trick easily, but you will win their return and you will still have a ♣ to get to dummy's 6 ♣ winners!

Ducking a ♣ is the only way to make the contract and you might as well do it at the second trick.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 7 2
 ♥ Q 9 4
 ♦ Q 10 9
 ♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ A 8 5 4 2

♣ 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 3

♥ J 10 8 5

♦ K J

♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ A K 5

♥ A K 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 4 2

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 2

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ 2, East plays the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners and dummy's ♦ suit is your only hope. **IF** ♦ s split 3-2 and **IF** the defenders don't take too many winners in their suit(s) you can establish ♦ s by ducking twice.

Win the first ♠. If you hold up they might pocket the ♠ trick and switch to another suit where you only have two stoppers.

Next play a small ♦ from each hand. Win the return (probably a ♠) and duck a second ♦.

If the defenders can only take 2 ♠ tricks now you are home-free since dummy's 3 ♦ s are now established.

You had to have the defender's ♠ s split 4-3. But in fact you were pretty sure they were going to do so. Since West's ♠ 2 was probably his fourth-down then he couldn't have a fifth-down.